MARLOW BASIN WATER DISTRICT

Request for Proposals No. MBWD-2026-14

Field Inspection and Asset Management Mobile Platform

Issue date	September 8, 2026
Written questions due	October 9, 2026, 5:00 PM Pacific
Proposals due	November 6, 2026, 2:00 PM Pacific
Procurement contact	Janet Okafor, Senior Procurement Analyst procurement@mbwd.example
Budget (not to exceed)	$1,150,000 for the initial three-year term

Marlow Basin Water District, Procurement Services, 400 Reservoir Way, Marlow, CA 95000

1. Introduction and Background

The Marlow Basin Water District (the "District") is a public water agency serving approximately 186,000 residents across a 410 square mile service area. The District operates two treatment plants, nine pump stations, 1,240 miles of distribution and transmission pipeline, and roughly 41,000 tracked assets, including valves, hydrants, meters, air release valves and pressure regulating stations.

Field inspection work is currently performed with a combination of paper forms and a tablet application whose vendor will end support on December 31, 2026. Inspection results are re-keyed into the District's computerized maintenance management system (CMMS) by office staff, typically three to five business days after the inspection. This delay, together with inconsistent photo documentation, was cited in the District's 2025 internal audit as a material weakness for regulatory reporting.

Through this Request for Proposals (RFP), the District seeks a commercially available, cloud-hosted mobile platform for field inspections and asset condition assessment that integrates with the District's geographic information system (GIS) and CMMS, works reliably in areas without cellular coverage, and can be adopted by a bilingual field workforce.

1.1 Goals

- Eliminate paper inspection forms and manual re-keying by the end of 2027.
- Make inspection results visible to supervisors and asset managers on the same day they are collected.
- Improve photo and location evidence for regulatory and insurance reporting.
- Support field crews who work for multiple consecutive days in areas without connectivity.
- Meet the District's vendor security requirements in ISP-07 (Information Security Policy for Third-Party Vendors).

1.2 Users and Devices

The platform will be used by approximately **240 field users** (inspectors, crew leads and seasonal staff) and **35 office users** (supervisors, asset management analysts and administrators). The District is replacing its field tablets in 2027 and will standardize on 12-inch Windows 11 tablets with integrated LTE and GPS. Approximately 60 existing iPads will remain in service through 2028.

Field crews typically work 10-hour shifts, four days per week. Vehicle charging is not available on all District vehicles.

2. Procurement Schedule

Milestone	Date
RFP issued	September 8, 2026
Optional pre-proposal conference (virtual)	September 22, 2026, 10:00 AM Pacific
Deadline for written questions	October 9, 2026, 5:00 PM Pacific
Answers and addenda published	October 23, 2026
Proposals due	November 6, 2026, 2:00 PM Pacific
Finalist demonstrations	Week of December 7, 2026

Milestone	Date
Board approval and contract award (target)	January 14, 2027
Production go-live	No later than 120 calendar days after contract award

The District reserves the right to modify this schedule by written addendum.

3. Scope of Work

The selected vendor ("Contractor") shall provide software licenses, hosting, implementation, integration, data migration, training and support for the platform described in this RFP. The scope includes:

- Configuration of approximately 35 inspection form templates currently in use (hydrant flushing, valve exercising, backflow, pump station rounds, reservoir inspection, meter audit and others).
- Two-way integration with the District's Esri ArcGIS Enterprise 11.1 environment for asset layers and inspection locations.
- Integration with the District's IBM Maximo 7.6 CMMS to create and close work orders from inspection results.
- Migration of five years of historical inspection records (approximately 310,000 records and 1.9 million photos) from the legacy system.
- Training for all field and office users, including a train-the-trainer program and on-site field sessions.
- Ongoing hosting, maintenance, upgrades and support for the contract term.

4. Requirements

Each requirement is designated **Mandatory (M)** or **Desirable (D)**. Proposers shall respond to every requirement in the Compliance Matrix (Attachment 1) with one of: *Fully meets*, *Meets with add-on or configuration*, *Will meet by a committed date*, or *Does not meet*, together with a short explanation. See Section 7.2 for how Mandatory requirements are evaluated.

4.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Type	Requirement
R-01	M	Native mobile applications for Windows 11 tablets and iPadOS 17 or later. The Windows application shall run natively on both x64 and Arm64 devices.
R-02	M	No-code configuration of inspection forms by District administrators, including conditional logic, required fields, picklists and calculated fields.
R-03	M	Photo capture of at least 20 photos per inspection, each automatically stamped with GPS coordinates, date and time.
R-04	M	Two-way integration with Esri ArcGIS Enterprise 11.x for asset layers, so that field edits to asset attributes are synchronized to the GIS.
R-05	M	Integration with IBM Maximo 7.6 to create, update and close work orders from inspection results.
R-06	M	Full offline operation for a minimum of **72 consecutive hours** without connectivity, including the ability to open any assigned asset record, view inspection history and complete new inspections, with automatic synchronization when connectivity returns. See Appendix A.

ID	Type	Requirement
R-07	M	Automatic resolution of synchronization conflicts with a complete audit trail of changes.
R-08	D	Barcode and QR code scanning of asset tags using the device camera.
R-09	D	Capture of digital signatures from crew leads and property owners.
R-10	M	A **Spanish-language user interface** for the field application, selectable per user, in addition to English. See Appendix B.
R-11	D	Supervisor dashboards showing inspection progress, overdue inspections and exceptions by crew and asset class.
R-12	M	Export of inspection data to CSV and PDF, and scheduled delivery of reports by email.

4.2 Technical and Security Requirements

ID	Type	Requirement
R-13	M	Single sign-on using SAML 2.0 with the District's Microsoft Entra ID tenant.
R-14	M	Automated user provisioning and deprovisioning using **SCIM 2.0**, so that District account changes are reflected in the platform without manual administration.
R-15	M	Multi-factor authentication for all users, enforced through the District identity provider.
R-16	M	Encryption of District data at rest using AES-256 and in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher.
R-17	M	Support for **customer-managed encryption keys**, held in a key management service controlled by the District, for data classified as Confidential under ISP-07.
R-18	M	All District data stored and processed in data centers located in the continental United States.
R-19	M	Retention of inspection records and photos for a minimum of **seven (7) years**, with search and retrieval available to office users throughout the retention period.
R-20	M	Notification to the District of any security incident affecting District data within **72 hours** of discovery, as required by ISP-07 Section 6.
R-21	M	A current SOC 2 Type II report and an annual independent penetration test, with summary results provided to the District each year.
R-22	M	Availability of at least 99.9% per calendar month, excluding scheduled maintenance, with service credits for missed targets.

4.3 Services, Support and Field Usability

ID	Type	Requirement
R-23	M	A train-the-trainer program for up to 12 District trainers and on-site training sessions for all field users, scheduled around crew shifts.
R-24	M	Production go-live, including GIS and CMMS integrations and data migration, within 120 calendar days of contract award.
R-25	D	The field application should support a full **10-hour shift** on District-issued tablets with location services active, without requiring the device to be recharged during the shift.

ID	Type	Requirement
R-26	D	Support available by phone from 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM Pacific, Monday through Saturday, with 24x7 support for Severity 1 incidents.

5. Pricing Requirements

Proposers shall submit firm, fixed pricing for an initial three-year term using the Price Form (Attachment 2). Pricing shall include all software subscriptions, add-on modules, hosting, implementation, integration, data migration, training, travel and any custom development needed to meet the Mandatory requirements.

The District's budget for the initial three-year term is **$1,150,000**, inclusive of all items above. Proposals exceeding this amount may be deemed non-responsive. Pricing for two optional one-year renewal terms shall be stated separately and is not included in the budget figure. Annual price increases for renewal terms shall not exceed 4%.

Subscription fees shall be invoiced annually in advance. One-time fees shall be invoiced against milestones defined in the Statement of Work, with 10% of implementation fees withheld until final acceptance.

6. Proposal Format and Submission

Proposals shall be submitted through the District's eProcurement portal by the deadline in Section 2. Late proposals will not be accepted. Proposals shall be organized as follows and shall not exceed 60 pages, excluding the Compliance Matrix, Price Form and required attachments:

- Tab 1: Cover letter signed by an authorized officer.
- Tab 2: Executive summary (maximum 3 pages).
- Tab 3: Technical approach and Compliance Matrix (Attachment 1).
- Tab 4: Security approach, including responses to ISP-07 and a current SOC 2 Type II report.
- Tab 5: Implementation plan, schedule and staffing.
- Tab 6: Three references from public utilities with at least 150 field users each.
- Tab 7: Price Form (Attachment 2), sealed separately.

7. Evaluation

7.1 Criteria

Criterion	Weight
Technical approach and fit to requirements	40%
Price	25%
Security and compliance with ISP-07	20%
Implementation approach, references and experience	15%

7.2 Mandatory Requirements

Mandatory requirements are evaluated on a pass or fail basis before scoring. A proposal that does not meet every Mandatory requirement may be deemed non-responsive. A response of *Will meet by a committed date* is acceptable only if the proposer commits contractually to deliver the capability **before production go-live** and states the delivery date and any associated cost in the Price Form.

Exceptions to ISP-07 may be requested in the proposal. The District's Chief Information Security Officer may grant time-limited exceptions under ISP-07 Section 10. Exceptions are not guaranteed and will be considered in the security score.

8. Questions and Communications

All questions shall be submitted in writing to Janet Okafor, Senior Procurement Analyst, at procurement@mbwd.example no later than **October 9, 2026 at 5:00 PM Pacific**. Answers will be published to all registered proposers by addendum. From the issue date until contract award, proposers shall not contact District Board members or staff other than the procurement contact regarding this RFP.

9. Contract Terms

- Contract term: three years from contract award, with two optional one-year renewals at the District's discretion.
- The District's Information Security Policy for Third-Party Vendors (ISP-07, version 3.2) is incorporated into the contract by reference.
- Insurance: commercial general liability of $2,000,000 per occurrence and cyber liability of $5,000,000 aggregate.
- The District owns all inspection data. On termination, the Contractor shall return all data in a documented, non-proprietary format and certify deletion as required by ISP-07.
- Liquidated damages of $1,500 per calendar day apply if production go-live is not achieved within 120 calendar days of award for reasons attributable to the Contractor.

Appendix A. Field Connectivity Conditions

A 2025 coverage survey found that 38% of the District's service area has no reliable cellular coverage, concentrated in the Upper Marlow Canyon, the Ridge Reservoir watershed and the eastern transmission corridor. Crews assigned to the Upper Marlow Canyon pipeline inspection program routinely work **three consecutive days** without connectivity and camp at District facilities between shifts.

Zone	Share of assets	Typical time without connectivity
Valley floor and urban core	54%	Under 1 hour
Foothill pressure zones	21%	2 to 8 hours
Ridge Reservoir watershed	11%	Up to 1 shift (10 hours)
Upper Marlow Canyon and eastern corridor	14%	Up to 72 hours

Inspectors must be able to open asset history, prior photos and open work orders for any assigned asset while offline, because condition assessments compare current conditions with prior inspections.

Appendix B. Workforce Language Needs

In the District's 2026 workforce survey, **31% of field staff** reported Spanish as their preferred working language, including 44% of seasonal staff. The District requires a Spanish-language interface for the field application so that inspectors can work in their preferred language. Form content (questions, picklist values and help text) will be authored by the District in both languages.

Appendix C. Current Environment

System	Details
Identity	Microsoft Entra ID, SAML 2.0 and SCIM 2.0 supported for all SaaS applications
GIS	Esri ArcGIS Enterprise 11.1, hosted on District infrastructure
CMMS	IBM Maximo 7.6.1, upgrade to Maximo Application Suite planned for 2028
Key management	District-operated cloud key management service, used for Confidential data
Field devices (2027)	12-inch Windows 11 tablets with LTE and GPS; 60 existing iPads (iPadOS 17)
Data classification	Inspection records: Internal-Restricted. Treatment plant and pump station asset locations: Confidential (critical infrastructure).